

A true nationalist can neither be a pretender nor a fence-sitter. He would always act decisively by his strong convictions. Why would such a person be repentant? The headline "Unrepentant Nationalist", thus, does not do justice to this wise and articulate man, who is a nationalist to the core.

ANJUM M. SAMEL, *Mumbai*

Ground Zero

The violence in Kannur is a blot on the face of society ("Old Battle New Ground", March 24). Communists have always been wary of losing their bastions and do not shy from violating the law. It is now up to the RSS to exercise self-restraint and raise their voice through peaceful means.

I.S. DUBE, *Varanasi*

Sticking the Wrong Way

There is only one way of revamping Indian hockey—giving a penalty kick to IHF President K.P.S. Gill as had been done to Greg Chappell with great result ("Lost Glory", March 24).

Y.N.I. ANAND, *on e-mail*

I fail to understand the reason for such a hullabaloo over the Indian hockey team's failure to qualify for the Beijing Olympics. Hockey is one of the most neglected sports in India. Ironically, even Shah Rukh Khan, who played the coach of the women's hockey team in *Chak De! India*, turned to cricket when it came to business.

A. VANI, *Hyderabad*

The IHF should take this defeat as a blessing in disguise and start

giving hockey the due encouragement and support it needs in a manner that the national game regains its past glory.

K.R. SRIIVASAN, *Chennai*

All of us are responsible for our hockey team's failure. If we had been only less enthralled by cricket—ironically a reminder of our colonial past—it would have done hockey and several other sports a lot of good.

MAHESH KUMAR, *Delhi*

Conscience Capers

Manmohan Singh has only given an aged bachelor, who is today lying on the shafts of politics, the grand title of Bhishma Pitamah (Voices, March 24). And when he asked Vajpayee to listen to his conscience, did Manmohan subtly hint that he hadn't been heeding it in the past? Or was this a way of belittling Advani?

J. N. BHARTIYA,

on e-mail

POLITICS OF ECONOMICS



The cover page of the "Now Vote For Us" issue was brilliant (March 17). Sonia Gandhi and Manmohan Singh with their hands folded in a *namaskar* rendered the headline below useless.

K.S.C. NAIR, *on e-mail*

Like reservation, the loan waiver too would turn out to be a Frankenstein that will devour our economy. While the founding fathers of the Constitution were guided by social justice, P. Chidambaram, the Harvard scholar, is guided by elections.

C. GOVINDAN NAIR, *on e-mail*

Budgets do not create any revolutions. They are nothing more than mere annual administrative rituals performed by finance ministers and this one by Chidambaram is no different.

T.S. PATTABHI RAMAN, *on e-mail*

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Years Ago in India Today

APRIL 16-30, 1978



Boo to Justice

"Sometimes this flattery becomes sickening." That was Justice J.C. Shah's verdict on the fawning courtiers of the Emergency—a tribe of senior politicians and officials represented by Jagmohan, former vice-chairman of the Delhi Development Authority. In an interview, he had heaped praise on Sanjay Gandhi for his "decisiveness, initiative and drive". Sanjay made a brief appearance before



Sanjay the commission on April 8. Like his mother, he too chose to defy Justice Shah and face prosecution. The summons, he said, had been served on his driver. The judge upheld the objection and "requested" him to receive fresh summons before leaving. Sanjay arrogantly demanded to know if he was being detained. "No," said the judge, "but I'd like you to wait." "I am busy," Sanjay retorted and left in the style he had come, encircled by Youth Congress muscle-men who shouted *zindabad*.

—Roopa Singh

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